

Live Progress Report 1 — after matches 1–2

Date: 2026-06-12 · **Matches recorded:** 2 of 104 · **Pipeline:** automated (v2, every 20 minutes)

1. Results against the locked picks

M	Fixture	Pick	Result	Points	E[points]	P(outcome)	Brier
1	Mexico – South Africa	2-1	2-0	1	1.02	0.672	0.166
2	South Korea – Czechia	1-1	2-1	0	0.74	0.361	0.613
	Cumulative			1	1.77		mean 0.389

Match 1 returned the predicted result with the wrong margin (one point of three). Match 2 missed: the model priced the fixture as a near-coin-flip (36/30/34) and the realistic readout settled on the draw; South Korea won it. One point against 1.77 expected is below par, on a sample of two — the running total concentrates around its expectation only over weeks, not days.

The expected-points column uses the corrected 3/2/1 expectation $E[S] = P(\text{result}) + P(\text{result} \wedge \text{GD}) + P(\text{exact})$. A formula error in the live pipeline’s expectation table (a stale two-tier (3,1) formula that understated every pick by ~15 percent) was found and fixed on 2026-06-12; realized points, outcome probabilities, and Brier scores were never affected.

2. What the results did to the forecast

Championship-level information content was 0.0011 bits (M1) and 0.0008 bits (M2) — both essentially zero, consistent with the pre-registered hypothesis that early group results barely move the title race. The champion table: Spain 27.1% → 26.9%, Argentina 18.1% → 18.3%, France 14.3% → 14.4% — all within Monte-Carlo noise of flat.

Inside Group A, however, the two results moved a great deal:

Team	Pts	GD	Advance (frozen → now)	Reach R16	Reach QF
Mexico	3	+2	91.8% → 98.7%	58.5% → 62.8%	27.0% → 29.2%
South Korea	3	+1	66.2% → 92.5%	27.8% → 41.3%	8.1% → 12.5%
Czechia	0	−1	68.0% → 50.5%	27.0% → 18.4%	7.1% → 4.9%
South Africa	0	−2	45.6% → 32.5%	8.1% → 5.3%	0.9% → 0.5%

The locked forecast had Czechia and South Korea effectively tied for the runner-up spot (68.0 vs 66.2) and named their opener as the decider; the opener has now decided it. Korea’s single win

was worth +26 points of qualification probability, because beating the direct rival is a double swing. Reality is converging on the locked finishing order — Mexico first, Korea second, Czechia advancing as a third-placer.

Spillover outside Group A is real but an order of magnitude smaller (largest moves ± 1.5 points, via the M73 routing, the third-place pool, and the T-slot draw). No champion probability moved beyond noise.

3. Machinery

The full automated cycle has now run end to end on real matches: PRE M1 (17:58Z, 62 min before kickoff) $\rightarrow$ POST M1 (21:10Z) $\rightarrow$ PRE M2 (01:31Z, 28 min before kickoff, conditioned on M1) $\rightarrow$ POST M2 (04:14Z). One incident: GitHub’s cron scheduler went silent for three slots (02:42–04:15Z); the hold-on-doubt gate ensured nothing was lost and the POST published on the next firing. No action needed, but the pattern is worth watching — if skips recur, moving the schedule off the congested :05/:25/:45 marks is the cheap hardening.

4. Next up

M	Fixture	Pick	E[points]
3	Canada – Bosnia and Herzegovina	2-1	0.87
4	United States – Paraguay	2-1	0.88
8	Qatar – Switzerland	1-2	1.06

Group A is idle until matchday 2 (M25 Czechia – South Africa, June 19 — now near-must-win for Czechia; M28 Mexico – South Korea, the de facto group-winner decider).

Generated from the live v2 records (`data/trajectory_v2.json`), the corrected expectation table (`data/match_expectations.json`), and conditioned re-simulation at $N=30,000$. Part of the pre-registered worldcup-prophet project; the locked forecast is unchanged at tag `prereg-2026`.